

DEVA ANAND

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NetApp, E-Series Engineering Team

Dear NetApp E-Series Engineering Team,

I am applying for the E-Series student contractor role on your engineering team. I am a master's student in Computer Science at UMass Amherst, and before grad school I spent two years as a backend engineer owning a multi-tenant production system with real users and sensitive data. The parts of this role that stand out to me, writing automation scripts, executing manual and automated tests, and keeping a real environment healthy, are exactly the parts of engineering I already care about most.

Testing and reliability are not overhead to me, they are the job. At Wysa I owned an NHS clinical triage backend serving 8+ UK clinical clients and over 10,000 monthly submissions, where I added integration tests and regression protection, hardened authentication and rate limiting, and remediated 20+ security-assessment findings. In my current work I am the sole engineer on a research NLP platform with a backend suite of 40 tests that runs hermetically in CI, and separately I built and hardened an agentic Python service backed by 150+ automated tests. When something breaks, I like getting to the bottom of it: I have used Spark UI stage metrics to localize shuffle and skew bottlenecks, and monitored production logs during releases to ship targeted fixes for tenant-specific incidents. Day to day I work in Python and Bash on Linux, with Git and CI as defaults.

I will be honest about where I would be learning. I have not worked hands-on in a hardware lab or with Ansible yet, but picking up a new tool quickly is something I do well and enjoy, and I learn fastest when I am a little out of my depth. NetApp rewarding initiative, ownership, and continuous learning is a big part of why this role appeals to me, and I would happily start by getting productive with your lab and automation tooling early. I am available part-time for 20 hours a week and am targeting a Fall 2026 term.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the chance to talk about how I can contribute to the E-Series team.

Sincerely,

Deva Anand